VOL 115 #5 SEPTEMBER - OCTOBER 2010

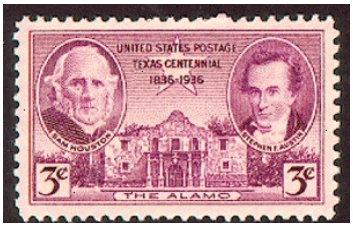
THE OFFICIAL PUBLICATION OF THE SAN ANTONIO PHILATELIC ASSOCIATION FOUNDED 1896

http://www.virtualstampclub.com/apstexas.html

The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388

T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3



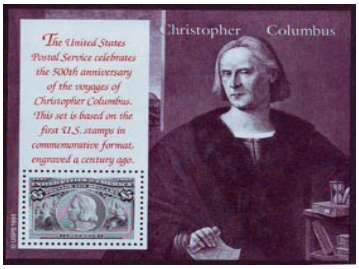
MEETING CALENDAR

SEPTEMBER			OCTOBER		
3	Juniors Board of Governors meeting General Meeting Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm 7:30 pm	1	Juniors Board of Governors meeting General Meeting Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm
10	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm	2	Sat. Boursette & Library Day -- Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:00 am
17	Juniors Program: "Nicholai Tesla" by Bob Joyce	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	8	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm
18	Sat. Boursette & Library Day -- Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:00 am	15	! BAG NIGHT !	7:30 pm
24	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm	22	Juniors Program: "Lure of the Orient" by John Clay	6:15 pm 7:30 pm
	Happy Halloween - Oct 31	BOO	29	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm

11/05 - Jrs, BOG&G, Show&Tell : 11/06 - Sat.Boursette : 11/12 - Auction : 11/19 - Jrs, Program : 11/26 - Thanksgiving

Labor Day - Sept 6 (Scott #1082)

Columbus Day - Oct 11 (Scott # 2629)



Editors' Corner

In honor of Labor Day, we thought we would tell you about the people who help to put together the newsletter you are reading. Your editors, Lea and Dora (who is also the membership chairperson), are responsible for getting the material gathered for each letter, checking for spelling and other errors, arranging the material on the pages, getting permission to reprint articles, finding interesting old items in past newsletters (we call it "Archive-ology"), printing, colating, stapling and folding the pages, and getting them into the envelopes, along with other inserts such as your membership cards. Whew!

If you have noticed Pat Richmond's name in numerous places, it's because she keeps track of who is doing programs on what. After the programs have been given, she writes down the information that was given to us during the programs, and takes pictures of the interesting items that have been shared with us. She also keeps the calendar current (a very big help for your editors!). The president of the club gives us an update on the club each time, and we also get information from Jack Virta, our auctioneer (he also organizes the Bag Night), and other board members when they need to get information to the members. All the envelopes are addressed to you with labels that are printed up by Fred Groth, our treasurer. The filled and addressed envelopes are given to Jack Virta, who affixes the postage, and delivers the envelopes to Richard Spies. Richard is a docent at the Institute of Texan Cultures, and he hand cancels the envelopes in the Institute's Post Office. Then the envelopes with the newsletters are delivered to all our members by the USPS.

That's a lot of people working to bring you the news about your club, isn't it?

Lea Senghaas and Dora Roberts

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta & Richard Spies

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
Philatex Editors
334 Olney Dr.
San Antonio, Tx 78209
Or email either of us.
lys@satx.rr.com dora.roberts@hotmail.com

Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	John Clay
Vice President:	Nelda Greer
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	Judy Grant
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneer:	John Clay
Librarian:	Richard Rose

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	John Clay
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Jane K Fohn
One year term:	Skip Swinney
Two year term:	Charles Shelby
Parliamentarian:	Bob Joyce
Honorary Board Member	Richard Spies

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Eire Philatelic Association:	Patrick J. Ryan
Texas Philatelic Association:	Robert J. Joyce
APS Circuit Books	John Clay

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities, and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourse, and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

Please wait until the end of the auction to pay for your purchases. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks are acceptable, made out to S.A.P.A.

Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Hi Again:

Well, the school year is beginning. Time to watch our driving and talking on the cell phones through the those school zones.

Friday the 13th is considered to be a bad luck day. But it wasn't for our club, although we thought it would be. It started out with the church using our regular meeting area for their rumage sale. We met in the choir practice room. The area may have been small, but we had an excellent auction and good membership turnout. Thanks to all that were there. Maybe we should hold our meetings there more often (just kidding). While we are on the topic of auctions, our members voted to approve the donation of no more than two nonphilatelic items per member to be auctioned off during each auction to help support the club. We will try it out starting in September.

The fall season is now near and our Saturday meetings are doing well. We are hoping for better turn outs as there are more stamps being offered for sale. Both Jack and myself have stamps for you to buy. If there are any more of you members that want to join in on the fun—*please do so*. Feel free!

Big Bad John

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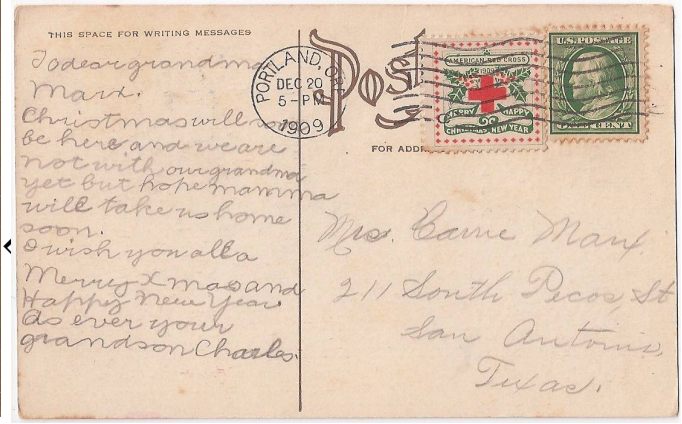
Program Notes July 23, 2010

"Holidays on Post Cards" by Chip Sweeney

Chip began with a brief history of the greeting card. The first card was in the 1400s at Valentine's Day. The oldest surviving card was printed in 1466. Homemade cards were fashioned by children during the reign of Queen Ann, but the popular Christmas card as we know it wasn't invented until the mid 1800s and the British take credit for that.

William Egley Jr, a 16 year-old British youth designed a 3 ½-inch-by 5 ½ inch card that is preserved in the British Museum. There are four holiday scenes and a "Merry Christmas and Happy New Year" greeting with blanks after the word "To" on the top and "From" at the bottom. The date is unclear, but appears to be either 1842 or 1849.

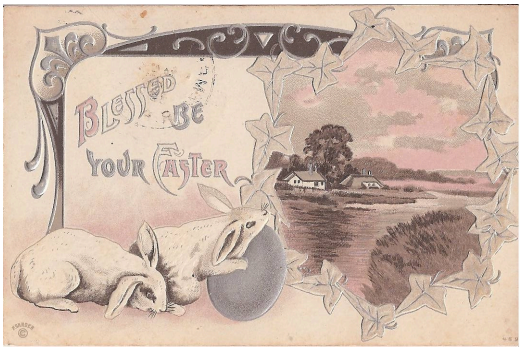
A Replica of the Egley Christmas Card

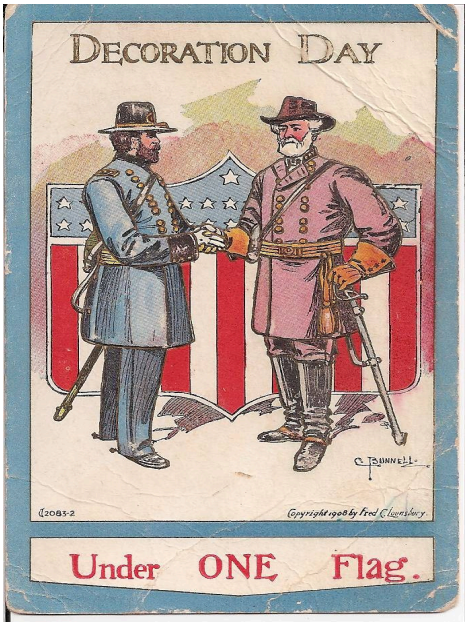


The holiday post card hit America in the late 1800s or early 1900s. Some antique dealers have them as early as 1905/1906.

The first card in Chip's collection was ⇦this New Years Day card to advertise 1910 with this little angelic child and her bird. The back shows that it was mailed in 1909, and incidentally has a Christmas seal on it also.

The following cards show the⇨ inclusion of animals in Easter post cards. The one with the rabbits has silver ink on it, is embossed and was mailed in 1913. The one with the chick and the filigree cart was mailed in 1918.





Chip is a geography teacher at Reagan High School in the Northeast Independent School District. He said that with each school holiday, he must explain to these high school students what some of the holidays or "off" days signify. He commented that some of these students think that July 4th is just a day to go to the lake and pop firecrackers.

⇦One of the cards from Chips patriotic section of his collection is a nice card that was used in 1919. Apparently, the War Between the States was still being emphasized as a day to honor the dead. Chip said that the theme that went throughout all these cards was "unification."

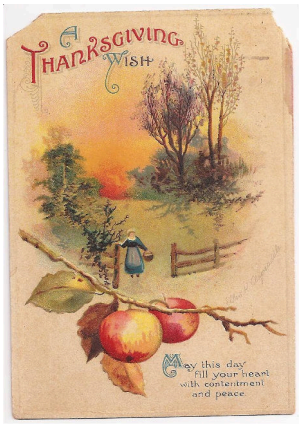
There are remnants of this disparity still in our society, unfortunately.

Although, Chip did not have any halloween cards, some of the members commented that they had seen them and in fact might have one or two in his/her collection/stuff. Watch out, Chip, you may be "bombarded" with cards of all seasons at the next bourse.

The next holiday that Chip had cards for was Thanksgiving.

This first card with the cute little⇨ pilgrim was mailed in Waco, Texas on November 28, 1911. You might want to check out the flag on the cancellation.

The next Thanksgiving card was made in Germany, mailed in Portland, Oregon on November 18, 1914 to Mrs. Carrie Marx in San Antonio, Texas and



was cancelled with a cancel that celebrated the World's Panama-Pacific Exposition of 1915 in San Francisco. Her daughter put a ⇦clever little sentiment on the card, "May your Thanksgiving be happy and when the dinner is through, may the biggest part of the wishbone be the end that is held by you."

Two of the Christmas cards were unusual. The first one of the children singing not only has 'Merry Christmas", but "Merry Xmas." This card was printed in 1908 and mailed ⇦that Christmas. The second one celebrates "A Merry Christmas" but has the Star of David painted on the ribbon and background. It was⇨ mailed in 1911 from Stamford, Texas to someone in Geronimo, Texas and is written in German.

Apparently, Mrs. Matthew, Superintendent of the M.E. Sunday School in Marquette, Kansas sent birthday cards to children in the nursery that were on the "Cradle Roll" of the church. Below are two examples. The left one is for the 2nd birthday and the right one is for the 3rd.

This entire collection was so interesting that I believe Chip has inspired some new card collectors. Imagine, researching the artists, the customs, etc.

Thanks, Chip, for a very interesting and informative program.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

New Postage Concept Introduced by USPS

The first stamp design in a new series features was released on May 17, 2010 at the National Stationery Show in New York City.

The 64¢ stamp picturing a Monarch Butterfly was issued by the USPS primarily for use on nonmachinable greeting card envelopes; thus the release at the Stationery show. The 64 cents pays the 44¢ First Class Letter rate plus the 20¢ "nonmachinable surcharge" that applies to envelopes that don't meet the envelope aspect ratio (length divided by height not within 1.3 to 2.5), are rigid and do not bend easily, contain items that cause the mailpiece to be uneven or have an address that is parallel to the shorter dimension of the letter (vertical setup).

Participating manufacturers will print a silhouette image of a butterfly on their envelopes, making it easy for customers to understand the new butterfly stamp or equivalent postage is all that is needed to mail the card. The prescribed image that is available from the USPS is reproduced here.

Artist Tom Engeman used images of mounted butterflies to inspire the stamp art he created by computer. The highly stylized, simplified image of a monarch is more the illusion of the butterfly than an exact replica. Derry Noyes incorporated Engeman's artwork into the stamp design.

The butterfly was chosen as a symbol that will be used for all future stamps for nonmachinable letters. When postal prices increase, USPS will issue a new butterfly design for this stamp.

The Butterfly stamp icon carries text that reads: 'Butterfly Stamp or Equivalent Postage Required." This implies that either the Butterfly stamp or postage totaling its value should be used.

The Greeting Card Association recommends that all square envelopes and those that fall within the nonmachinable letter category carry the Butterfly stam icon in the upper right-hand corner, thus making it easier for all concerned to determine postage for greeting cards and invitations that fall within the "nonmachinable" specifications.

Shown here enlarged, but proportional, the dimensions of the Butterfly stamp are 1¼" x 1¼" while the Butterfly stamp icon measures 1⅛" x 1⅛". This size differential allows the icon to fit completely beneath the actual stamp. The USPS also specifies that the icon should be placed 3/16" from the top and right edges of the envelope, thus allowing room for the placement of the stamp.

Derry Nowes also was the Art Director and the Typographer for the project. The Engraver credit was assigned to Trident and the Modeler credit to Avery Dennison.

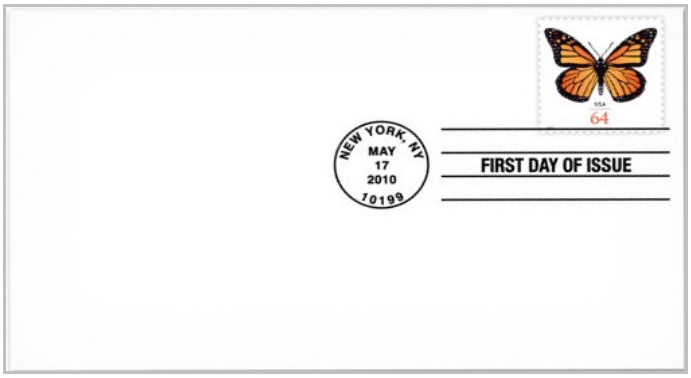
The stamps were gravure printed by Avery Dennison. An initial print run of 20 million pressure-sensitive adhesive stamps were produced. Colors used to print the stamps were cyan, magenta, yellow, black, cool gray and orange. Plate numbers in the four corners of the 20-stamped pane consist of the letter "V" to identify Avery Dennison as the printer followed by six single digits, one for each print color.

My thanks to Mekeel's & Stamps Magazine for their kind permission for me to reprint this article from their June 11, 2010 issue in our newsletter. They can be contacted at: <http://www.stampnewsnow.com>, phone 800-635-3351, or mail to Stamp News, 42 Sentry Way, Merrimack, NH, 03054.) Since the July 19th deadline for sending in your own cover for a FDC has passed, I have included the following information from the USPS Postal News bulletin instead.

How to Order First-Day Covers

Stamp Fulfillment Services offers first-day covers for new stamp issues and Postal Service stationery items postmarked with the official first-day-of-issue cancellation. Each item has an individual catalog number and is offered in the quarterly USA Philatelic catalog. Customers may request a free catalog by calling 1-800-STAMP-24 or writing to:

Information Fulfillment
Dept. 6270
U.S. Postal Service
P.O. Box 219014
Kansas City, MO 64121-9014



The item # for the Butterfly Stamp FDC is #114661.

We will have our Blue Chip Auction on December 3, 2010. Our auctioneer, Jack Virta, needs to receive all lots for the auction by September 24th. This is because in order to publish the list of lots in the Nov.-Dec. Philatex, they must get to us (your Editors) by October 8th, to be mailed out on October 19th. The lots will be on display at the 1st and 3rd club meetings of November. Please also note that there is a change in the minimum catalog value of each lot. For many years, the minimum catalog value of each lot has been $5.00. It has been decided that each lot for this auction must have a minimum catalog value of $15.00. As always, mail-in bids and other in-advance bids will be accepted. Contact Jack at 826-4826.